Matthew Lau

Artist, Singapore

My work explores the relationship between people and machines through interactive light. Light is a medium that connects across different kinds of understanding, and through responsive lighting environments I turn abstract computational ideas into sensory experiences that can be felt before they are explained.

By making visible what usually stays hidden — the algorithms, processes and machine-learning principles that increasingly shape our world — the work pushes back on the idea of artificial intelligence as an inscrutable black box. Earlier pieces made latent spaces legible as colour and light. The newer ones ask what such a system does when it is left alone with itself, learning from its own output until its range collapses.

Underneath this is a belief that technology should deepen human connection rather than thin it out. The installations treat the machine as a collaborator rather than a tool, setting up a dialogue in which human intention and computational process both shape what is finally seen.

Contact

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Group exhibitions

Reconstructed Colours — 2026
Techno Terra: Archive of the Future, Gallery 1, Institute of Contemporary Arts Singapore

Forms Drifting, in collaboration with Neuewave/MDRN — 2026
I SAW IT, Singapore Art Week 2026, Flock at Kampong Java, Singapore

Circulated Densities — 2025
Singapore: A Design Thesis in the Making, Gallery 1, Institute of Contemporary Arts Singapore

Deconstructed Ambiance — 2025
Beyond Interface & Prompt: Exploring the Language of Technology in Contemporary Art, WAH Center (Williamsburg Art & Historical Center), Brooklyn, New York

Ambi(latent) Space — 2025
to be CONTINUED – a work in progress show, NYC Resistor, Brooklyn, New York

Deconstructed Colours — 2023
Threads: A Critical Craft Collective Experiment, Draft #2, Earl Lu Gallery, Institute of Contemporary Arts Singapore

The Oort Cloud and the Blue Mountain, with Neuewave/MDRN, Andreas Schlegel & Hazel Lim-Schlegel — 2022
Singapore Art Week 2022, Tanjong Pagar Distripark, Singapore

ASICS Art in Motion Campaign — 2022
Pop-up activation, Alchemist, Design Orchard, Singapore

NewWave (shown as *Sea of Debris*), in collaboration with Neuewave/MDRN — 2021
Archifest 2021, Singapore

NewWave, in collaboration with Neuewave/MDRN — 2021
Farewell To Reason, by (KSY) Nathan Yong, Industry+, Singapore

The Oort Cloud and the Blue Mountain, with Neuewave/MDRN, Andreas Schlegel & Hazel Lim-Schlegel — 2021–2022
Kinderbiënnale 2021, Groninger Museum, Groningen, Netherlands

The Oort Cloud and the Blue Mountain, with Neuewave/MDRN, Andreas Schlegel & Hazel Lim-Schlegel — 2021–2022
Children's Biennale 2021, Japanisches Palais, Staatliche Kunstsammlungen Dresden, Germany

Education

Master of Professional Studies, Interactive Telecommunications
New York University, Tisch School of the Arts, ITP, New York — 2023–2025
Thesis: *Ambi(latent) Space* — Edge Machine Learning for Adaptive Lighting Systems. IMDA SG Digital Postgraduate (Media) Scholarship.

BA (Hons) Design Communication, First Class Honours
LASALLE College of the Arts, Singapore — 2020–2022
Dissertation: *Hello, I'm Here* — Affective Computing Light Installation, from Affective Communication Research. LASALLE Scholarship.

Diploma in Design Communication, with Distinction
LASALLE College of the Arts, Singapore — 2014–2017
A foundation in design communication and core design principles, and in how design shapes cultural and social contexts.